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An Intimate Relationship with God

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An Intimate Relationship with God

"I know you by name." (Exodus 33:17, ESV)

The Bible tells us that life in this world and the world to come is all about having a growing *relationship* with almighty God. We are not talking here about a relationship of convenience or superficiality; God wants an intimate relationship with us! Jesus Christ came into the world to give us that relationship with God, and our decision to accept salvation through Christ has major implications for not only eternity, but for the time we have remaining in this world.

Being a Converterlator is all about having a right relationship with Jesus Christ and having his Word and life personally operating in your life. This is a tremendously exciting place to be! When we have a growing *relationship* with God, we experience his favor and blessing. And if we have the favor and blessing of God, what else could we ever need? To have his presence and the truth of his Word operating in our lives through Christ living his life in us truly makes us a different people.

Moses modeled this principle for us. The living presence of God in his life was paramount. In fact, he did not want to proceed with the tasks God had for him without having God's very presence in his life. "And he said to him, 'If your presence will not go with me, do not bring us up from here'" (Exodus 33:15, ESV).

This kind of *dependence* on God is not possible without *knowing* God and *understanding* how he thinks. This means we must not only *begin* a relationship with him, but go on to *develop* an intimate relationship with him in order to truly *experience* his presence in our lives. Moses realized that if he ever hoped to find favor in God's sight, he needed to know God in a deeper way when he said, "Now therefore, if I have found favor in your sight, please show me now your ways, that I may know you in order to find favor in your sight" (Exodus 33:13, ESV).

What we are talking about here is developing an *intimacy* with God the Father, Jesus Christ, and the Holy Spirit. *Relationship* is not about external rules or a list of what to do and not to do. *Relationship* is about *being with* someone. When we like to be around a person, we make time to be with them. We like to experience their presence for increasing time periods. Each one of us needs to be spending time with God!

There are many things that can keep us from having an intimate relationship with God: other people, confused priorities, “stuff,” busyness, you name it! The Converterlator is willing to swim upstream against the world system. We have a different worldview. We live differently, act differently, and are motivated by factors unknown to most of the world.

This is not to say that life will be easy. There *will* be hard times, but God will be there with us. In my first book, *KingdomNomics*, I recounted how I experienced the Lord lifting a spirit of oppression from me. I have also experienced his presence as I lived through some very difficult situations. He *does* work in our circumstances.

What are you currently doing to develop and grow in your relationship with your heavenly Father?

Converterlators have an intimate relationship with God through Jesus Christ.